

ESSENTIAL

Document Checklist by Applicant Type

Self-funded - Family-funded - Scholarship/Sponsored - Switching routes

Every applicant needs

- Your CAS statement (a copy of what your sponsor submitted, for your own records and to check against)
- Valid passport or travel document
- Financial evidence meeting the maintenance requirement (see the Financial Requirements Overview) - covering the required period and held for the required 28 consecutive days
- Academic qualification certificates or transcripts your sponsor's offer was conditional on, if not already verified directly with your sponsor

If your course requires it

- ATAS certificate - for eligible postgraduate research courses and nationalities only; confirm with your sponsor's international office whether this applies to you
- TB test certificate - required if you're resident in a country on the current TB testing list; check gov.uk for the current list and approved clinics

If you're self-funding

- Personal bank statements covering the required 28-day period, showing the full required amount held throughout
- If funds are held overseas or in a currency other than pounds sterling, be prepared for the conversion to be assessed at the exchange rate on the day of your application

If a parent or relative is funding you

- Their bank statements covering the same 28-day period, showing the required amount
- A letter confirming the relationship and their commitment to fund your course - see the Sponsor & Financial Letter Templates (Complete tier)
- Evidence of the relationship itself (e.g. your birth certificate, for a parent)

If you're sponsored by a government, university scholarship, or official scheme

- An official confirmation/sponsorship letter from the sponsoring body, covering fees and/or living costs as applicable - this can substitute for personal bank evidence for the amount they're covering
- If the sponsorship only covers part of the cost, you'll still need to evidence the remainder yourself

If you're switching from another UK visa

- Evidence your new course represents academic progression from your current one (a higher academic level, or a genuinely related subject where progression rules allow it)
- Your current visa/eVisa details and, if applicable, your current sponsor's permission to release your CAS early

If you're under 18 at the time of application

CHILD STUDENT ROUTE

Applicants under 18 fall under the Child Student route rather than the standard Student route, with some different requirements (including parental consent and different accommodation/welfare arrangements). This document set covers the standard (18+) Student route - check gov.uk directly if you'll be under 18 at the time of application.